Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Interval recognition, chord-function hearing, sung guide tones, dictation, and immediate realization

SECTION X | EAR -> VOICE -> HAND

Level 76 reconstructed music in layers. Level 77 shortens the delay between hearing and playing: identify the interval or function, sing the structural tone, and place it on the fretboard without exploratory searching.

1. Hear

Name contour, interval, or harmonic function before looking at the neck.

2. Sing

Produce the target pitch with the voice before the guitar confirms it.

3. Realize

Play the sung target immediately in a requested register or string set.

Ear-to-hand response ladder

```
HEAR      source is played once or twice
LABEL     interval / degree / function
SING      target without guitar support
LOCATE    choose string and register silently
PLAY      one decisive attack
VERIFY    compare voice and guitar
TRANSFER  repeat in a second register
```

Written workload

Module	Events
A - intervals	144
B - function	96
C - guide tones	120
D - dictation	128
E - call/response	128
F - realization	112
G - reaction	96
H - capstone	128
TOTAL	952

No-search rule

After the target is sung, the fretting hand gets one silent setup and one attack. Sliding around until the note is found defeats the exercise. If the first attack is wrong, stop, name the error, sing again, and restart the cell.

SOURCE METHOD: partner performance is ideal. For self-study, record the source cards once, shuffle playback order, wait several minutes, and answer without viewing the source page.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module A - interval atlas: sing, identify, and place

12 INTERVALS | REFERENCE MAP

LEARN THE SOUND IN BOTH DIRECTIONS; SONG MNEMONICS ARE OPTIONAL, NOT THE FINAL SKILL

Interval	Semitones	Reference	Sing upward	Sing downward
m2	1	C-Db		
M2	2	C-D		
m3	3	C-Eb		
M3	4	C-E		
P4	5	C-F		
TT	6	C-F#		
P5	7	C-G		
m6	8	C-Ab		
M6	9	C-A		
m7	10	C-Bb		
M7	11	C-B		
P8	12	C-C		

Practice: hear root -> sing interval -> play it. Then hear the upper note -> sing downward to the root. Use C only as the first reference; later modules randomize the root.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module A - ascending and descending interval dictation

24 CELLS | 96 TONES

ANSWER INTERVAL QUALITY BEFORE NAMING THE SECOND PITCH

Card	Start	Destination	Direction	Answer
1	C	Db	up	m2
2	D	E	up	M2
3	E	G	up	m3
4	F	A	up	M3
5	G	C	up	P4
6	A	D#	up	TT
7	B	F#	up	P5
8	C	Ab	up	m6
9	D	B	up	M6
10	E	D	up	m7
11	F	E	up	M7
12	G	G	up	P8
13	B	Bb	down	m2
14	A	G	down	M2
15	G	E	down	m3
16	F#	D	down	M3
17	E	B	down	P4
18	D	Ab	down	TT
19	C	F	down	P5
20	B	D	down	m6
21	A	C	down	M6
24	E	E	down	P8

Fretboard pass: source names only the starting note and interval. Player sings the destination, then plays it on a specified string without first playing the root.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module A - interval transfer from random roots

12 ROOTS | 48 REALIZATIONS

THE INTERVAL SOUND MUST SURVIVE TRANSPOSITION

Card	Given root	Requested interval	Sing destination	Low / mid / high
1	C	M3		
2	F#	P5		
3	Bb	m3		
4	E	M6		
5	Ab	P4		
6	D	m7		
7	B	M7		
8	F	M2		
9	C#	TT		
10	G	m6		
11	Eb	m2		
12	A	P8		

After the first correct note, repeat the same pitch class in two other registers without re-singing. This converts interval hearing into immediate neck navigation.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module B - major-key chord-function hearing

7 FUNCTIONS | TONIC / PREDOMINANT / DOMINANT

HEAR WHAT THE CHORD WANTS TO DO, NOT ONLY WHAT QUALITY IT HAS

Roman	Family	Functional sensation	Sing after chord	Resolve
I	tonic	home / rest	root then 3rd	I
ii	predominant	moves toward V	root then 3rd	I
iii	tonic family	weak tonic substitute	root then 3rd	I
IV	predominant	opens away from I	root then 3rd	I
V	dominant	strong return pressure	root then 3rd	I
vi	tonic family	relative-minor color	root then 3rd	I

Three-function compression

```
TONIC       I  iii  vi
PREDOMINANT ii IV
DOMINANT    V  vii dim
```

Blind test

Partner plays one diatonic chord in C, G, D, A, E, or F major. Answer function family first; Roman numeral second; chord name third.

Do not infer function from fretboard shape. Repeat the test with rootless triads or shell voicings.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module B - function dictation through progression families

12 PROGRESSIONS | 96 CHORD EVENTS

WRITE T-P-D-T SHAPE BEFORE ROMAN NUMERALS

Key	Source progression	Roman answer	Function answer
C	C-F-G-C	I-IV-V-I	T-P-D-T
G	G-C-D-G	I-IV-V-I	T-P-D-T
D	Em-A-D-D	ii-V-I-I	P-D-T-T
A	A-E-F#m-D	I-V-vi-IV	T-D-T-P
E	C#m-A-E-B	vi-IV-I-V	T-P-T-D
F	F-Gm-Bb-C	I-ii-IV-V	T-P-P-D
C	C-Am-F-G	I-vi-IV-V	T-T-P-D
G	Am-D-G-G	ii-V-I-I	P-D-T-T
D	D-A-Bm-G	I-V-vi-IV	T-D-T-P
A	F#m-D-A-E	vi-IV-I-V	T-P-T-D
E	E-F#m-A-B	I-ii-IV-V	T-P-P-D
F	Dm-Bb-F-C	vi-IV-I-V	T-P-T-D

Second pass: source performer omits the tonic chord at the end. Player sings the tonic root, then plays the nearest tonic triad without searching.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module C - sung guide tones in major harmony

10 VOICES | 60 SUNG TARGETS

THE THIRD AND SEVENTH ARE SUNG BEFORE THE CHORD IS PLAYED

Chord	Guide 1	Role	Guide 2	Role	Task
Cmaj7	E	3	B	7	sing both -> play shell
Dm7	F	b3	C	b7	sing both -> play shell
G7	B	3	F	b7	sing both -> play shell

Major ii-V-I voice-leading

```
Dm7 -> G7 -> Cmaj7
F   -> F  -> E        lower guide voice
C   -> B  -> B        upper guide voice
```

Sing each line alone; then sing one while playing the other.

Transposition command: move the ii-V-I guide-tone pair through G, D, A, E, and F major. The voice must be sung from the chord name and function, not copied by fret distance.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module C - sung guide tones in minor and dominant harmony

10 VOICES | 60 SUNG TARGETS

HEAR THE RAISED LEADING TONE BEFORE THE HAND MOVES

Chord	Guide 1	Role	Guide 2	Role	Task
AmMaj7	C	b3	G#	7	sing both -> play shell
Bm7b5	D	b3	A	b7	sing both -> play shell
E7	G#	3	D	b7	sing both -> play shell

Minor iiø-V-i voice-leading

```
Bm7b5 -> E7 -> Am7
D     -> D  -> C
A     -> G# -> G
```

Critical sung motion: A -> G# -> G and G# -> A.

Dominant test: partner plays E7 without its third. Player sings G# and adds it on the guitar. Repeat for A7, D7, G7, C7, and B7.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module D - melodic dictation from scale-degree contour

8 PHRASES | 64 TONES

WRITE DEGREE CONTOUR BEFORE EXACT NOTE NAMES

Context	Degree answer	Pitch answer	Contour / confidence
C major	1-2-3-5-3-2-1	C-D-E-G-E-D-C	
C major	5-6-5-3-2-1	G-A-G-E-D-C	
G major	1-3-2-5-4-3-2-1	G-B-A-D-C-B-A-G	
D major	5-3-2-1-7-1	A-F#-E-D-C#-D	
A minor	1-b3-4-5-b7-5-b3-1	A-C-D-E-G-E-C-A	
E minor	5-4-b3-2-1	B-A-G-F#-E	
A harmonic minor	5-b6-7-1-7-5	E-F-G#-A-G#-E	
A melodic minor	1-2-b3-5-6-7-1	A-B-C-E-F#-G#-A	

Three passes: 1) U/D/S contour only. 2) scale degrees. 3) exact notes. The guitar is used only after all three written layers are committed.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module D - rhythm-plus-pitch melodic dictation

8 TWO-BAR CELLS | 64 TONES

PITCH AND RHYTHM ARE TRANSCRIBED SEPARATELY, THEN RECOMBINED

Card	Context	Pitch contour	Rhythm layer	Rebuild
1	C major	1-2-3-5-3-2-1	quarters	
2	C major	5-6-5-3-2-1	eighths	
3	G major	1-3-2-5-4-3-2-1	q q 2eighths	
4	D major	5-3-2-1-7-1	pickup &4	
5	A minor	1-b3-4-5-b7-5-b3-1	syncopated 3+3+2	
6	E minor	5-4-b3-2-1	triplet q	
7	A harmonic minor	5-b6-7-1-7-5	late-sixteenth pickup	
8	A melodic minor	1-2-b3-5-6-7-1	half + q q	

Verification: clap the rhythm without pitch; sing the melody without rhythm; then recombine. If either isolated layer fails, do not blame the combined phrase.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module E - call-and-response reproduction

8 PAIRS | 64 SOURCE + 64 RESPONSE TONES

REPRODUCE THE QUESTION EXACTLY BEFORE INVENTING AN ANSWER

Chord	Question	Exact echo	Answer model
Cmaj7	C-E-G-E	write/play exact	G-B-E-C
Dm7	D-F-A-F	write/play exact	A-C-F-D
G7	G-B-D-F	write/play exact	F-D-B-G
Am7	A-C-E-G	write/play exact	G-E-C-A
Fmaj7	F-A-C-E	write/play exact	E-C-A-F
Bm7b5	B-D-F-A	write/play exact	A-F-D-B
E7	E-G#-B-D	write/play exact	D-B-G#-E
AmMaj7	A-C-E-G#	write/play exact	G#-E-C-A

Pass 1: exact echo. Pass 2: same rhythm, new pitches. Pass 3: same contour, new register. Pass 4: answer on the next chord while preserving phrase length.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module E - delayed call-and-response memory

8 MEMORY DELAYS | 64 TONES

THE PHRASE MUST SURVIVE A SILENT DELAY BEFORE THE HAND MOVES

Card	Source question	Required delay	Reproduction / answer
1	C-E-G-E	1 beat	
2	D-F-A-F	2 beats	
3	G-B-D-F	1 bar	
4	A-C-E-G	2 bars	
5	F-A-C-E	4 beats + count	
6	B-D-F-A	1 bar + sing tonic	
7	E-G#-B-D	2 bars + name chord	
8	A-C-E-G#	4 bars + transpose	

Do not silently finger the phrase during the delay. Keep the memory auditory: sing internally, count, and form the hand only when the response begins.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module F - immediate fretboard realization from named degrees

14 COMMANDS | 56 REALIZATIONS

ONE SILENT SETUP, ONE ATTACK; THEN TRANSFER THE SAME FUNCTION TO ANOTHER REGISTER

Context	Requested degree	Answer pitch	Low	Mid	High
C major	3	E			
C major	7	B			
G major	3	B			
D major	7	C#			
A major	6	F#			
E major	2	F#			
F major	4	Bb			
A minor	b3	C			
A minor	b7	G			
E minor	5	B			
D minor	b6	Bb			
A harmonic minor	7	G#			
A melodic minor	6	F#			

Partner names only context + degree. Player sings pitch name, then plays low/mid/high locations. No root note is supplied by the guitar.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module F - immediate chord-tone realization

14 COMMANDS | 56 TONES

HEAR THE ROLE, SING THE NOTE, THEN PLACE IT INSIDE THE CHORD

Chord	Role	Pitch	Sing	String set 1	String set 2
Cmaj7	3	E			
Cmaj7	7	B			
Dm7	b3	F			
Dm7	b7	C			
G7	3	B			
G7	b7	F			
Am7	b3	C			
Am7	b7	G			
Bm7b5	b5	F			
E7	3	G#			
E7	b7	D			
AmMaj7	7	G#			
D7#11	#11	G#			

Guide-tone priority: if response time is slow, practice only thirds and sevenths until they are immediate; roots and fifths are added afterward.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module G - timed reaction ladder

12 COMMAND SETS | 96 EVENTS

SPEED IS MEASURED FROM THE END OF THE COMMAND TO THE FIRST CORRECT ATTACK

Stage	Command type	Response limit	Required response
1	named note	4 sec	sing + one location
2	interval from root	4 sec	sing destination + play
3	scale degree in key	4 sec	name + sing + play
4	chord tone	4 sec	role + sing + play
5	named note	3 sec	two registers
6	interval from root	3 sec	two registers
7	scale degree	3 sec	two registers
8	chord tone	3 sec	two string sets
9	named note	2 sec	one decisive attack
10	interval	2 sec	one decisive attack
11	degree / function	2 sec	sing then attack

A wrong fast response scores below a correct slower response. Accuracy reaches 90 percent before the time limit is reduced.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module G - random-function command deck

24 PROMPTS | 96 EVENTS

MIX INTERVAL, DEGREE, FUNCTION, AND CHORD-TONE QUESTIONS SO THE EAR CANNOT PRELOAD ONE TASK

1. C + M3

Answer: _____

2. F# + m3

Answer: _____

3. Bb + P5

Answer: _____

4. E + M6

Answer: _____

5. C major degree 7

Answer: _____

6. G major degree 3

Answer: _____

7. A minor degree b6

Answer: _____

8. A harmonic minor degree 7

Answer: _____

9. Cmaj7 third

Answer: _____

10. G7 b7

Answer: _____

11. Dm7 b3

Answer: _____

12. Bm7b5 b5

Answer: _____

13. Function of V in D

Answer: _____

14. Function of ii in G

Answer: _____

15. Function of vi in C

Answer: _____

Shuffle prompt order between sessions. Partner may read prompts aloud without showing the page.

16. Sing V->I roots in A

Answer: _____

17. Sing 3->7 of Cmaj7

Answer: _____

18. Sing b7->3 of G7

Answer: _____

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module H - 16-bar ear-to-hand model: source card

SOURCE PLAYER ONLY | 64 TONES

RECORD ONCE; TRANSCRIBER SHOULD NOT STUDY THIS PAGE BEFORE THE TEST

Bar	Chord	Four-note source	Structural target
1	Cmaj7	E-G-B-C	E
2	Am7	C-E-G-A	C
3	Dm7	F-A-C-D	F
4	G7	B-F-D-G	B
5	Cmaj7	B-G-E-C	B
6	E7	G#-B-D-E	G#
7	Am7	C-E-G-A	C
8	A7	C#-E-G-A	C#
9	Dm7	F-A-C-D	F
10	G7	B-D-F-G	B
11	Cmaj7	E-G-B-C	E
12	D7	F#-A-C-D	F#
13	Gmaj7	B-D-F#-G	B
14	Am7	C-E-G-A	C
15	D7	F#-C-A-D	F#

Perform at one comfortable pulse. Keep note lengths even and avoid emphasizing the first pitch beyond the normal beat-one accent.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Module H - 16-bar reconstruction worksheet

5 PASSES | 64 ANSWERS

REBUILD THE SOURCE WITHOUT SEARCHING FOR EACH NOTE

Bars	Contour	Degrees	Exact notes	Chord / function	Play
1-4					
5-8					
9-12					

Realization rule

After the exact notes are written, sing each four-note bar once and play it immediately in one chosen position. Then repeat the complete 16-bar source in a second register.

Score each block 0-2 for hearing accuracy and 0-2 for first-attack fretboard accuracy. Maximum = 16.

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Level 77 capstone - unfamiliar 16-bar ear-to-hand reconstruction

NO CHART | ONE SOURCE -> ONE PERFORMANCE

THE CAPSTONE COMBINES HEARING, SINGING, MEMORY, FUNCTION, AND IMMEDIATE FRETBOARD REALIZATION

Source requirements

Use an unfamiliar 16-bar excerpt containing at least four chord qualities, one dominant resolution, one repeated melodic motif, one syncopated rhythm, and one section or tonal landmark. Partner source or self-recorded source may be used.

Seven-pass reconstruction

1. Form / pulse
2. Bass / roots
3. Chord function
4. Rhythm
5. Melodic contour
6. Guide tones / exact notes
7. Immediate fretboard realization

Performance requirement

Sing the first structural target of every four-bar block before the take. Then perform the complete reconstruction without restarting. If one pitch is missed, preserve the pulse and move to the next structural target instead of searching.

Category	0	1	2
Interval / degree hearing	mostly guessed	mixed	reliable
Chord function	lost	partial	clear
Guide-tone singing	unstable	mostly right	in tune
First-attack accuracy	frequent search	some misses	decisive
Call / response memory	lost	partial	recognizable
Complete performance	stops	recovers	continuous

Guitar Exercises - Section X, Level 77

Practice progression, mastery gate, and Section X direction

ADVANCE BY RESPONSE QUALITY, NOT SPEED ALONE

THE EAR SHOULD BEGIN TO PREDICT THE HAND BEFORE THE HAND MOVES

Ten-phase practice progression

- [ ] 1. Interval atlas
- [ ] 2. Interval dictation
- [ ] 3. Random-root transfer
- [ ] 4. Function hearing
- [ ] 5. Major guide tones
- [ ] 6. Minor guide tones
- [ ] 7. Melodic dictation
- [ ] 8. Call and response
- [ ] 9. Timed realization
- [ ] 10. 16-bar capstone

Error diagnosis

Wrong pitch, right contour -> interval issue

Right pitch after search -> neck-location issue

Right chord, wrong function -> context issue

Voice right, guitar wrong -> ear-hand mapping

Echo degrades after delay -> memory issue

Fast wrong answers -> increase response window

Mastery gate

- [ ] Identify all twelve intervals ascending and descending at >= 90%.
- [ ] Sing thirds and sevenths through major ii-V-I and minor iiø-V-i.
- [ ] Transcribe eight short melodies by contour, degree, rhythm, and exact pitch.
- [ ] Echo all eight call-and-response questions after a one-bar delay.

Next direction

Level 78 will integrate ear-led playing with improvisation: hearing a target before playing it, singing-and-answering through chord changes, motif prediction, anticipatory guide-tone lines, and spontaneous accompaniment/lead role switching.

The long-term goal is not perfect pitch. It is reliable relative hearing connected directly to musical function and fretboard action.